

# 29 Everyday problems

Prefixes that mean "not" are called negative prefixes. Many words that have negative prefixes are useful for talking about everyday workplace and urban problems.

 **New language** Negative prefixes

**Aa Vocabulary** Urban problems

 **New skill** Talking about everyday problems

## 29.1 KEY LANGUAGE NEGATIVE PREFIXES

Negative prefixes change a word's meaning to its opposite.

Maria is very organized. Her desk is always tidy.



Kevin is very **dis**organized. His desk is always **un**tidy.



The opposite of "organized."

The opposite of "tidy."



## 29.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES NEGATIVE PREFIXES

The traffic is so bad it's **im**possible to get to work on time.



I think you've **mis**understood what I was trying to say.



It's **ir**responsible to drive faster than the speed limit.



It's **il**legal to park in the middle of the road.



## **Aa** 29.3 FILL IN THE GAPS USING THE WORDS IN THE PANEL

They were so unlucky to miss the train this morning.

- 1 It's \_\_\_\_\_ to solve a problem when you don't have all the facts.
- 2 Her room is so \_\_\_\_\_ that you can't even see the floor.
- 3 He's very \_\_\_\_\_, so I always have to check to confirm our meetings.
- 4 It's \_\_\_\_\_ to download that movie without paying for it.

untidy

illegal

~~unlucky~~

impossible

disorganized

